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Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.

Finding fire safety, security, and inventory gaps hiding behind a 6-year-old SOP



A leading FMCG enterprise engaged Sthiros for an internal audit of its high-volume, ASRS-enabled warehouse operations, covering governance, safety, security, and inventory control.

Client	Service	Sector	Geography
A Leading FMCG Company (Name Confidential)	**Internal Audit, Warehouse Governance & Control Framework**	**FMCG, Supply Chain & Warehousing**	**India**

The Challenge:

When automation outpaces the SOPs meant to govern it

This organisation's high-volume, technology-enabled warehouses, including Automated Storage and Retrieval Systems, had evolved far beyond the legacy SOPs still governing them, last updated in 2017-18, creating governance, safety, and control gaps across multi-location operations.

Outdated Governance Framework

Warehouse SOPs remained unchanged since 2017-18 despite GST implementation and ASRS adoption, with multiple unapproved documents used as reference.

EHS Fire & Safety Control Gaps

The Fire Alarm Control Panel failed to monitor key safety components, with fire extinguisher reserves below the required buffer and missing emergency equipment.

Security & Surveillance Weaknesses

Access control SOPs were not followed at the gate, CCTV command centre placement was insecure, and several cameras were non-functional with no access log.

Inventory Control & Process Deviations

Suspected damaged goods were posted directly to final SAP location without temporary blocking, and ASRS verification guidelines had not been updated.

Approval & Compliance Gaps

Emergency plans were approved by third-party personnel instead of designated authority, with no centralised oversight for SOP approvals.

The Solution:

A comprehensive warehouse governance and control framework

Sthiros delivered a comprehensive warehouse governance and control enhancement framework, aligned to operational realities across governance, safety, security, inventory, and monitoring.

Every recommendation was built to close the specific gap it addressed, from SOP standardisation to CCTV reconfiguration to inventory movement protocols, rather than a generic checklist.

The Methodology

1 Governance & SOP Standardisation

Warehouse SOPs recommended for update to reflect ASRS operations, GST environment, and revised inventory verification practices, with formal approval at management level.

2 EHS & Safety Strengthening

FACP monitoring capability enhanced, Emergency Control Centres completed, fire safety equipment replenished, and PPE and monsoon preparedness reinforced.

3 Security & Surveillance Enhancement

Digital access control systems implemented at gatehouses, CCTV infrastructure reconfigured, and qualified security leadership deployed.

4 Inventory Control & Process Discipline

Standard inventory movement protocols enforced, including temporary blocking before final classification, with physical verification strengthened in the ASRS environment.

5 Monitoring & Compliance Framework

Periodic reviews by EHS and warehouse management strengthened, training programmes reinforced, and accountability for deviations established.

What This Means

SOPs age out with the technology.

Safety equipment needs a buffer, not a minimum.

Access control means a log, not a gate.

Outcomes

5

Critical gap categories identified

Spanning governance, fire safety, security, inventory, and compliance across warehouse operations.

6+ Years

SOP gap identified

Warehouse SOPs unchanged since 2017-18, despite GST implementation and ASRS adoption.

Validated

Inventory accuracy

No major deviations observed during physical verification, with process-level gaps flagged for correction.

Enterprise-Wide

Governance roadmap delivered

A structured alignment plan for standardised operations across every warehouse location.

Get in touch

Is your warehouse governance current, or just historical?

Speak to Sthiros about what a structured warehouse governance audit can unlock for your operations.

Connect with us:
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